

State Review Learnings:

University of Arkansas – Monticello

Alternative Route

On-Site Review: November 19–20, 2025

WHAT'S IN THIS REPORT?

The report uses evidence from state data collection and an onsite review to examine educator preparation program performance. The information in this report is meant to inform a continuous improvement process that takes educator preparation programs closer to the goals needed to serve Arkansas's students.

This report rates the EPP on all three Standards of the Arkansas Education Preparation Provider State Review Framework, which are fundamental to support teacher candidates in their journey to becoming successful teachers who meet the needs of students in Arkansas:

- Standard 1, “Candidate Recruitment and Completion,” is rated primarily with quantitative data from state data collection.
- For Standard 2, “Preparing Candidates Effectively,” criteria to assess performance results from document review, observations, and focus group conversations with stakeholders, including teacher preparation program deans, candidates, current school leaders and teachers, faculty, and the DESE staff.
- The ratings for Standard 3, “Supporting Workforce Needs,” are based on state data reporting.

Performance Levels are defined as follows:

Performance Level	Average Score Equivalent
EXCEEDS	Average score equivalent to exceeds on two of three standards or indicators
MEETS	Average score equivalent to meets on all three standards or indicators
APPROACHING	Average score equivalent to approaching on one standard or indicator and meets on the other two
BELOW	Average score equivalent to below on one standard or indicator and approaching on the other two

University of Arkansas - Monticello

Alternative Route

Overall Performance Level		
APPROACHING		
Performance Levels by Standard		
Standard 1: Recruitment & Completion	Standard 2: Preparing Candidates Effectively	Standard 3: Supporting Workforce Needs
MEETS	APPROACHING	MEETS

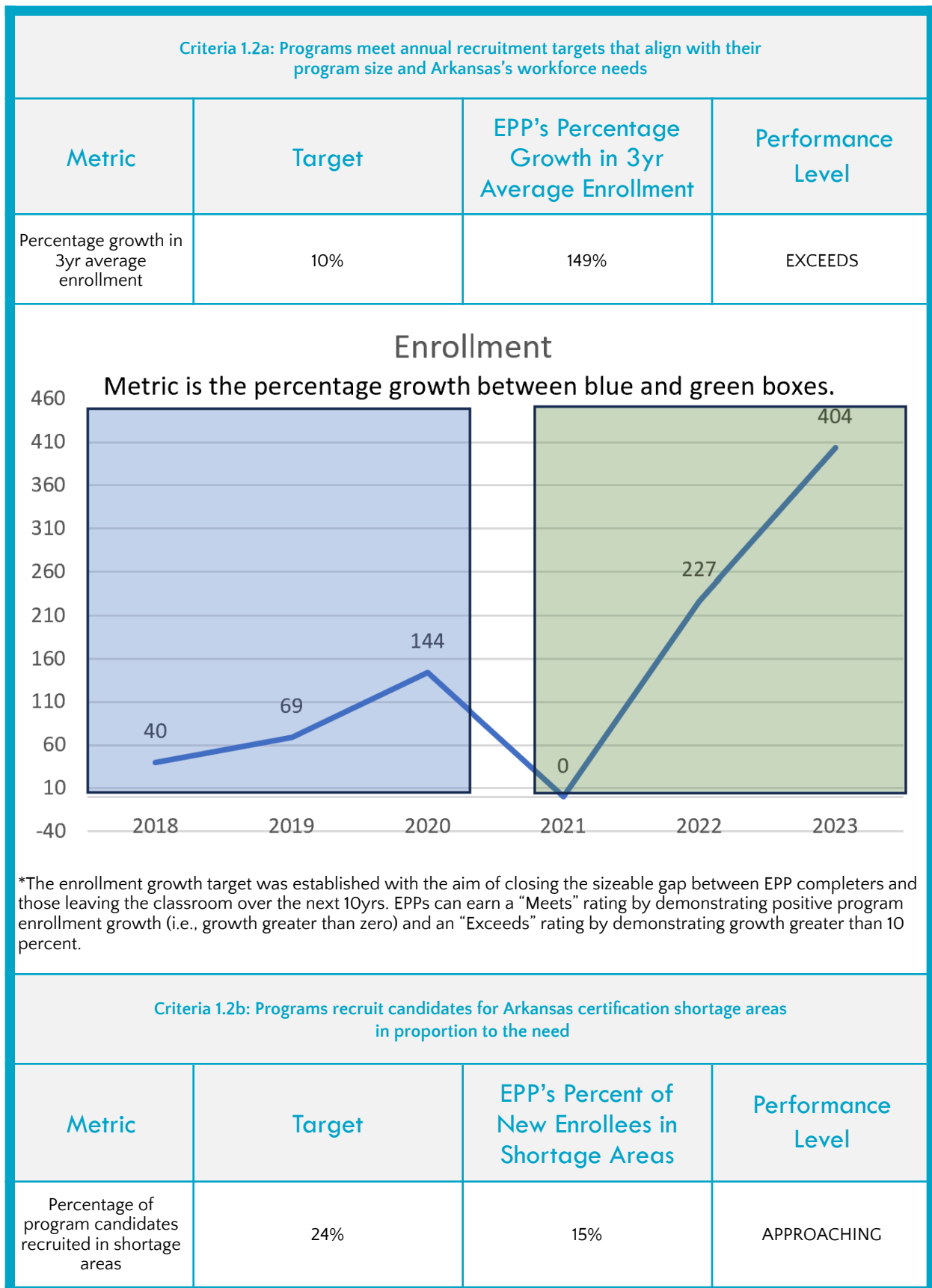
Standard 1: Recruitment & Completion

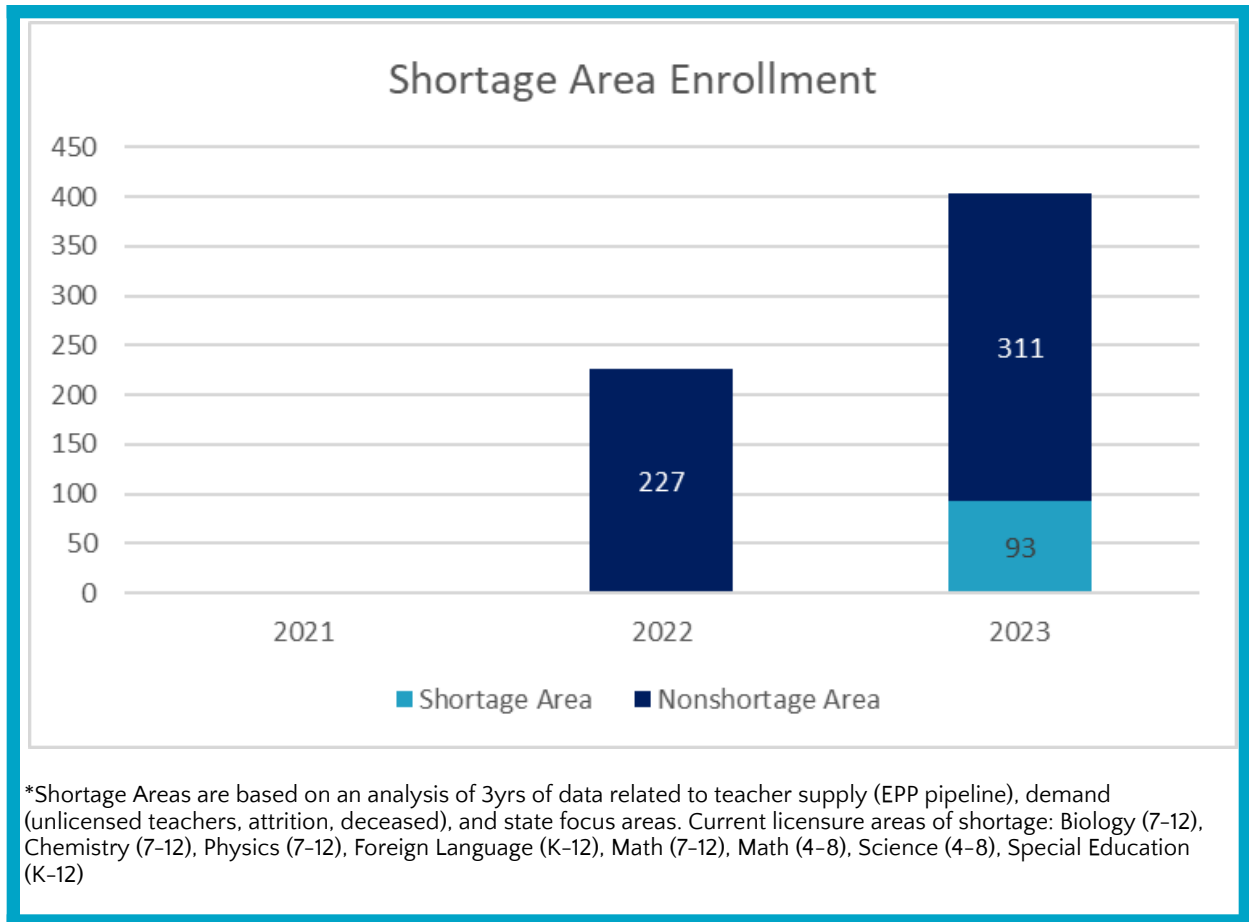
Standard 1 Performance Level		
MEETS		
Indicator Performance Levels		
Indicator 1.1 Plans	Indicator 1.2 Recruitment	Indicator 1.3 Completion
MEETS	MEETS	MEETS
Recommendations		
Recommendations include: Recruiting additional candidates to increase overall enrollment, particularly in subject shortage areas, will support the program's Standard 1 performance moving forward. <i>(Focus Areas: Criteria 1.2a)</i>		

INDICATOR 1.1: PLANS

Criteria 1.1a: Programs have formal plans to meet the targets described in the state review framework (i.e., Standards 1-3) and show evidence of acting on their plans	
Performance Level	Explanation
MEETS	The UA-Monticello Alternative Program Annual Plan addresses each aspect of the state framework and realistically assesses the program's challenges in regard to the geographic region of the state.

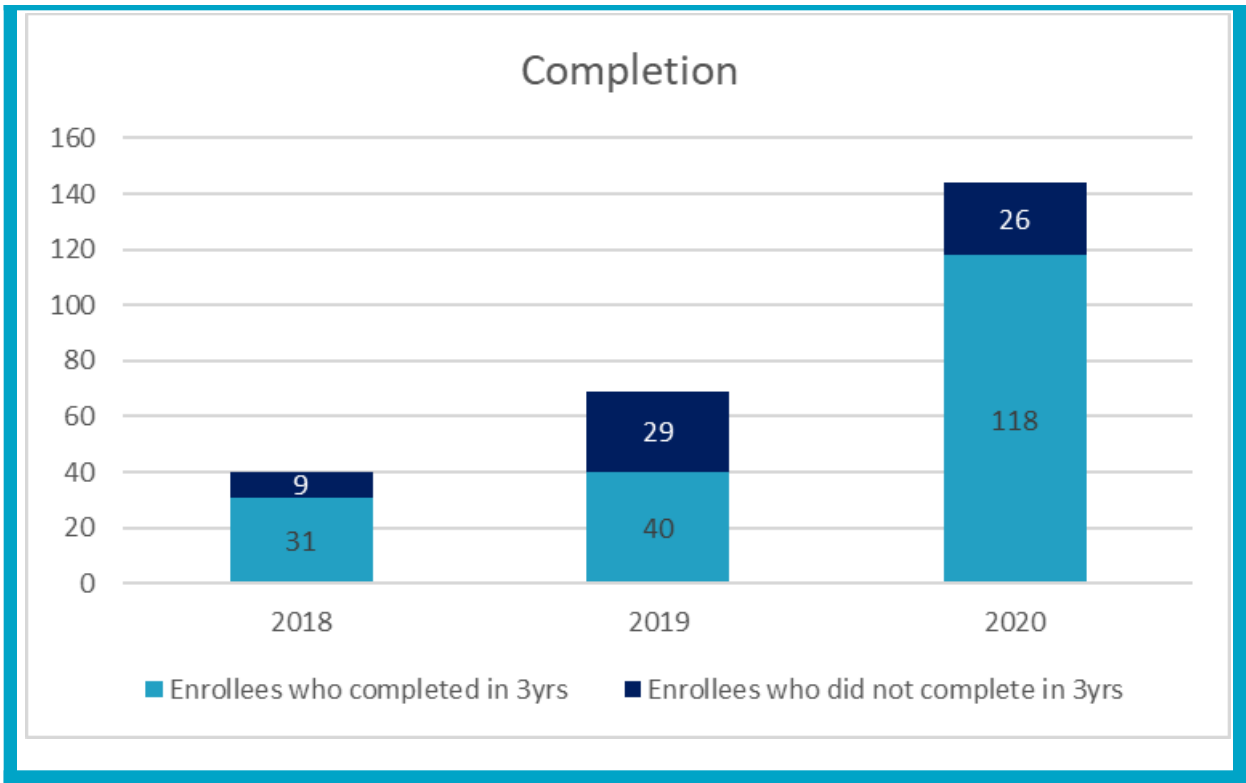
INDICATOR 1.2: RECRUITMENT





INDICATOR 1.3: COMPLETION

Criteria 1.3a: Candidates have high rates of completion			
Metric	Target	EPP's 3-Year Completion Rate	Performance Level
Three-year average completion rate	75%	75%	MEETS



Standard 2: PREPARING CANDIDATES EFFECTIVELY

Standard 2 Performance Level		
APPROACHING		
Indicator Performance Levels		
Indicator 2.1 Coursework	Indicator 2.2 Clinical Experiences	Indicator 2.3 Development
APPROACHING	APPROACHING	MEETS
Recommendations		
The alternative program at UA-Monticello provided evidence of its commitment to preparing teacher candidates to be day-one ready and continues to refine and strengthen its program. Course instructors and clinical supervisors are a strength, providing strong instruction and support to candidates. Recommendations to strengthen candidate preparation include: - Audit coursework for classroom connections, ensuring that instructors provide models of instruction, incorporate high-quality instructional materials, clearly and intentionally familiarize candidates with Arkansas K-12 Standards, and reflect with participants on the alignment between coursework and the classroom. <i>(Focus Areas: Criteria 2.1a Metrics 1 and 2, Criteria 2.1b Metric 3)</i> - Continue to refine a clear, intentional process to fully support graduate students in their internship experience, including opportunities to expose them to a variety of experiences, especially for candidates already in a teacher-of-record role. Build and maintain strong relationships with schools where teacher candidates work, even if they are outside the current list of partner districts. <i>(Focus Areas: Criteria 2.2a Metric 2, 2.2c Metric 1)</i> - Ensure all candidates receive consistent feedback from clinical supervisors and experienced mentor teachers that is aligned to the ATR, includes evidence of student learning, and actionable feedback <i>(Focus Area 2.2b Metric 4)</i>		

INDICATOR 2.1: COURSEWORK

Criteria 2.1a: Candidates receive high-quality program coursework that is evidence-based
APPROACHING
Metric 1: Incorporation and demonstration of best practices around content instruction APPROACHING Program documents indicate that coursework is designed to incorporate nationally recognized best practices, including HQIM and evidence-based instructional strategies. Syllabi reference SoR-aligned content, developmental learning theory (e.g., Piaget), and assignments requiring analysis of effective versus ineffective instruction, PLC collaboration, and standards-based lesson planning. MAT syllabi also include HQIM and SoR resources such as Scarborough's Reading Rope. However, because no course artifacts, lesson samples, or instructional materials were provided, the review team could not confirm how consistently these practices are implemented in actual instruction. In the coursework teacher candidate focus group (n=2), participants described limited and inconsistent exposure to HQIM and national best practices. One candidate noted that courses "used helpful books and workbooks," but did not

provide enough guidance on evaluating HQIM, and only one participant gave a concrete example of using HQIM in coursework. The *Intro to Reading* course introduced SoR concepts but did not offer comprehensive preparation. In contrast, instructor participants (n=5) described intentional use of UDL, Marzano's strategies, co-teaching, explicit instruction, and HQIM analysis across courses. This discrepancy suggests planned inclusion of best practices but uneven candidate experience.

Observational evidence showed partial alignment with best practices, such as candidates applying developmental theory through hands-on Piaget tasks and using authentic texts for HQIM-aligned vocabulary work. Other observed lessons, however, showed minimal modeling of HQIM, limited application of SoR, and reliance on general strategies without clear grounding in evidence-based practice. With limited observation opportunities and no supporting artifacts, the team could not verify consistent implementation across programs.

Metric 2: Incorporation and utilization of Arkansas K12 Standards in coursework as a foundation for teacher development
APPROACHING

Program documents show that coursework is designed to incorporate the Arkansas K–12 Standards, particularly in reading and assessment courses, where candidates are expected to integrate standards into lesson planning and analyze how skills progress across grade levels. READ 50133, for example, aligns Science of Reading content with Arkansas literacy standards and requires candidates to design standards-based lessons. However, several courses referenced developmental theory or instructional practices without explicitly tying assignments to state standards, and in one MAT syllabus, the only mention of standards appeared in *Side-by-Side Progressions* without corresponding tasks requiring their use. Because assignments, unit plans, and candidate work products were not available, the depth and consistency of standards integration across the program cannot be fully verified.

In the teacher candidate focus group, participants described using progressions to examine how standards build over time, selecting standards to design assessments, and breaking standards into teachable components. One candidate noted that PLC experiences clarified vertical alignment “more than the coursework,” helping them see what students should know before and after the grade they teach. While these examples demonstrate meaningful interaction with the standards, they appear limited to certain courses rather than consistently embedded practice.

Observation evidence reflected partial integration of standards, including lessons where candidates identified prerequisite skills and aligned instruction to grade-level expectations. SPED coursework reinforced this by requiring alignment of individualized supports with standards. Other observed sessions, however, emphasized general pedagogy or developmental theory without explicit connections to standards.

Criteria 2.1b: Candidates' coursework supports their development as a teacher
APPROACHING

Metric 1: Sequence and progression of courses
APPROACHING

Courses are somewhat sequenced across programs of study to build off previous coursework. MAT courses follow a logical sequence: foundational, specialized, and clinical experiences. The Syllabi tracker and program of study documents confirm the progression of coursework. For example, in Introduction to Teaching and Assessment (EDHP 50633), the course begins with methods and lesson planning, leading to more advanced courses, such as Advanced Teaching and Assessment. (EDHP 50733).

Candidates in the Coursework focus group (n=2) agree that their courses have become more rigorous, with one participant noting that, when they transferred from the BSE program to the MAT program, the graduate-level courses were more in-depth. However, they also noted that some courses were redundant, including the same course they had taken at the undergraduate level. Candidates also pointed out discrepancies between the lesson plan template they use in the classroom and the one required for the program. Course instructors (n=9) acknowledged that, since candidates are already in the school, they may not get specific coursework when they need it, but that the instructors share access to all the material at the beginning and try to add supplemental information to better support candidates.

Metric 2: Incorporation and utilization of Arkansas Educator Competencies and Arkansas Teaching Standards in coursework
MEETS

Coursework intentionally incorporates Arkansas Teaching Standards in a way that develops candidates to gain the knowledge and skills of their required licensure areas. The “Syllabi Tracker” maps each course against these competencies and standards. For example, the “MAT ATS Matrix” demonstrates alignment between coursework and the Arkansas Teaching Standards.

In the focus group, course instructors (n=9) provided additional examples of how to incorporate standards into coursework. Candidates are expected to “bring in a standard, know where to find their standard, and identify the end goal” of instruction. For example, candidates select a content area of interest, such as physics, and discuss that interest, finding an appropriate standard to teach and how it connects to aviation. This is an example of the ATS expectation that teachers connect disciplinary knowledge to real-world applications. Additionally, candidates analyze Science and HQIM expectations to consider “what is needed to know depending on the interest of the student” and why certain knowledge matters, reinforcing standards-based instructional decision-making. Since ATS is aligned with InTASC and TESS, and ATR is used within the coursework, candidates routinely engage with the frameworks they will apply in practice.

Reviewers saw evidence of the Arkansas Teaching Standards in the coursework observations. For example, in Psychological Foundations (EDFD50683), the Teacher Interview project allows candidates to analyze classroom practices and reflect on instructional strategies, addressing competencies related to understanding student development and effective pedagogy. The Piaget Cognitive Development Signature Assessment engages candidates in designing, implementing, and analyzing experiments, developing skills in evidence-based instruction, assessment, and data-driven decision-making, which are key components of the Arkansas Teaching Standards. Additionally, the Pre- and Post-Teaching and Learning Philosophy essays encourage candidates to reflect on their growth in applying educational theories to practice, fostering professional knowledge, ethical practice, and instructional planning aligned with state educator expectations.

Metric 3: Alignment of coursework to clinical experience

MEETS

Coursework is aligned with clinical experiences, and candidates have opportunities to reflect on the alignment. Clinical experiences are integrated into coursework, providing candidates with real-world teaching applications. Candidates are required to complete video reflections, which demonstrate the application of course content in clinical settings. The “MAT Intern II Lesson Plan and Reflection(ELA)” shows how candidates design and reflect on lessons using state standards. Finally, the edTPA task and Pop Cycles directly align coursework with their teaching experiences, and provide opportunities for pre- and post-observation discussion.

Candidates in the Coursework focus group (n=2) agree there is alignment between their coursework and clinical experience. One candidate mentioned the feedback they receive, especially on lesson plans, has been “overwhelmingly positive.” Another candidate mentioned that the coursework has helped them in their role as a tutor. Course instructors (n=9) agree there is intentional alignment. One instructor said, “We are discussion-based, learning from each other based on what content they are teaching and at what level.” Another said, “Everything we are doing in class, they can take back to their classroom. Reviewers observed alignment during a course observation. They noted that the course emphasizes the practical application of educational theory in real-world teaching contexts. Projects such as the Biographical Sketch (Project 1) encourage self-reflection and professional development, enabling students to connect their personal experiences with their teaching practice. The Teacher Interview (Project 3) enables students to observe and analyze classroom management and motivational strategies, directly linking educational psychology concepts, such as the Zone of Proximal Development, to practical teaching.

Criteria 2.1c: Candidates are provided with knowledgeable and effective course instructors

MEETS

Metric 1: Quality of course instructors

MEETS

Most course instructors show deep knowledge of the Arkansas K-12 Standards, content knowledge, and pedagogy. The evidence provided in the “Course Instructor/Clinical Supervisor List” shows that instructors hold advanced degrees (M.Ed., Ed.D.) and have extensive teaching experience. Five are enrolled in doctoral programs. Many instructors have dual certifications and participate in professional development (e.g., conferences, Science of Reading training, coaching programs).

Candidates in the Coursework focus group (n=2) agree that their instructors are knowledgeable. One participant shared that the videos they provide are well-crafted and align with the content and standards being taught.

Additionally, instructors actively engage in discussion boards, responding to student posts with thoughtful, reflective comments. Course Instructors (n=9) shared how they stay current through ongoing studying and reading, research-based scholarly activities, and publishing. "One participant highlighted how SPED faculty publish newsletters and secure grants that keep them up to date, suggesting that most instructors actively seek and share timely, field-specific knowledge. Additionally, teams of faculty attend HQIM training and learn from their peers to continue their own learning.

Metric 2: Effectiveness of course instructors MEETS

Most course instructors have a proven history and show evidence of strong facilitation of coursework, including feedback and support. Instructors' effectiveness is measured through student surveys, peer reviews, and self-assessments. The document "MAT Course Evaluations" shows that 100% of respondents agree their course instructors are effective and knowledgeable. Course evaluations collected each semester play a key role in the annual faculty review process.

Both candidates in the Coursework focus group agree that their instructors are knowledgeable and noted that the videos and feedback they received have been helpful. Course instructors discussed giving feedback weekly or more frequently when requested, as "vital to the candidate's learning."

Reviewers noted evidence of the course instructor's effectiveness during course observations. In the MAT Internship course, reviewers highlight that the syllabus "demonstrates clear organization, detailed student learning outcomes, and structured lesson plan requirements, suggesting that the instructor has a strong knowledge of planning, instruction, assessment, and classroom management." They also note the assignments foster engagement, classroom discussion, reflection, and encourage a deep understanding of teaching.

INDICATOR 2.2: CLINICAL EXPERIENCES

Criteria 2.2a: Candidates are provided clinical experiences throughout their program that support their development as a teacher

APPROACHING

Metric 1: The sequence of clinical experiences APPROACHING

The overall sequence of clinical experiences builds on prior experiences and offers opportunities for learning and development. Program documents outline a progression of development across the residency year; however, there is little evidence of clinical experiences outside of their role as teacher of record. The MAT Handbook indicates that interns complete six scored assessments, including two POP Cycles each semester of their internship, with required lesson plans, video submissions, supervisor observations, and reflective post-conferences. The "University Supervisor Meeting Agenda" shows that both Internship I and II require two 10-minute walkthrough videos followed by a complete POP Virtual Cycle, as well as completion of edTPA Task 1 in Internship I and Tasks 2 and 3 in Internship II.

Candidates in the Clinical Experience focus group (n=9) agree that their clinical experience increases in rigor over time; however, most of their experiences are a result of previous classroom roles and their current role as a teacher of record. One participant said, "I had to do a couple of PD days. I was hired in August, and I am in Internship I right now." In the Clinical Supervisor focus group (n=3), participants focused on the POP cycle as part of a sequence of the clinical experience. They acknowledged that candidates go straight into a job and then take coursework, but did not provide additional evidence to highlight a clear sequence for candidates.

Metric 2: The variety of clinical experiences APPROACHING

The overall variety of clinical experiences provides some opportunities for candidates to work with students of varied learning needs. While MAT candidates serve as the teacher of record in a number of schools across the state, as seen in the "Demographic Data Map MAT," and are naturally exposed to a variety of students, there was no evidence of intentional opportunities by the MAT program to work with students of varied needs.

In the Clinical Experience focus group (n=9), participants agreed they've been exposed to a variety of learning needs. However, they explained that those experiences are due to the makeup of the classroom, not the MAT program. One

participant said, "I have seven students in my room with IEPs, and I was already pretty knowledgeable on SOR because I taught it for three years when I did interventions. The Reading courses in our MAT program have helped me make connections to ensure I understand the process and can support these students." Clinical Supervisors (n=3) reinforced MAT experiences based on where candidates are hired and the established PLC systems within each setting. One clinical supervisor has observed MAT participants observing other teachers; she couldn't confirm if it is a program requirement.

Criteria 2.2b: Candidates across the program are provided with an effective clinical internship
APPROACHING

Metric 1: The effectiveness of experienced mentor teachers
APPROACHING

While some experienced mentor teachers appeared qualified based on their credentials, there was no evidence that they consistently provided coaching or feedback to support candidates' pedagogical development. EMT Information spreadsheets for Internship I and Internship II (Fall 2025) listed mentor teacher names, licensure areas, and "yes/no" responses regarding Lead/Master designation and coaching training; however, these responses appeared to be self-reported by the teacher candidates and lacked supporting documentation. Coaching templates provided in the evidence—such as pre- and post-conference questions and the Aspiring Teacher Rubric—were tools used by university supervisors, not by experienced mentor teachers. The "Mentor Teacher Log" included an email exchange in which an EMT reported observing improved classroom management and lessons for one candidate, but no additional evidence demonstrated consistent EMT coaching practices.

All participants in the Clinical Experience focus group (n=9) confirmed they work with an experienced mentor teacher. Candidates expressed that mentors provide consistent, personalized support and actionable guidance that impacts classroom practice and professional growth. For example: "My mentor has helped answer and raise questions I didn't even know I had; for example, when I first started, I was letting kids come up to my desk constantly and didn't realize how much time it was taking from my class, and she saw it and pointed it out and has been super helpful."

Note: By 2026-2027, experienced mentor teachers working with year-long residents must have received the DESE-recognized coaching training. [Arkansas Novice Teacher Mentoring Manual](#)

Metric 2: Quality of selection process for experienced mentor teachers
APPROACHING

A partial process exists for selecting experienced mentor teachers (EMTs) based on criteria outlined in the MAT Handbook, which specifies that EMTs must have at least 3 years of classroom teaching experience and exemplary evaluations. EMT spreadsheets for Internship I and II (Fall 2025) list EMT names, licensure areas, and "yes/no" responses regarding Lead/Master designation and coaching training; however, these responses appeared to be self-reported by interns and were not supported with documentation, limiting evidence of a fully implemented selection process. Although program documents state that experienced mentor teachers are designated by the district and must hold effective annual evaluations, complete Cognitive Coaching training, and utilize the Aspiring Teacher Rubric, the submitted evidence did not clearly verify these requirements.

Participants in the School Partners focus group (n=4) stated, "When selecting lead and master within our building, we are very selective up front. We vet them to ensure the personality is encouraging and caring, and that there is proven student achievement data. That they have the true knowledge to mentor." All participants agreed with this statement.

Metric 3: Quality of clinical supervisors
APPROACHING

Program documentation indicates that some clinical supervisors have relevant credentials and training to support candidate development. A supervisor roster lists degrees, licensure areas, and experience, and one Cognitive Coaching certificate was provided. University Supervisor Meeting Agendas reference the use of the Aspiring Teacher Rubric (ATR) and note access to Student-Centered Coaching training through IDEAS, with Fall 2025 materials identifying scheduled training opportunities. While these materials suggest that some supervisors are prepared to coach candidates effectively, evidence of consistent, program-wide coaching preparation was limited. Only one supervisor had documented Cognitive Coaching certification, and the supervisor roster appeared aligned mainly with the undergraduate program, making it difficult to determine whether most supervisors demonstrate a proven history of effective instructional coaching.

In the teacher candidate focus group (n=8), all participants stated that their clinical supervisors helped them become more effective teachers. Candidates primarily described support as being responsive and accessible, particularly in answering questions about assignments or helping candidates stay organized. One candidate shared, “I probably called them 100 times... asking about our latest assignment, and they answered all my questions,” while another noted that their supervisor “sat down with me and listed all the things I needed to have completed because I got overwhelmed.” While these examples reflect strong relational support, candidates did not consistently describe coaching that focused on instructional improvement, goal setting, or measurable impact on teaching practice.

Observational evidence showed mixed coaching quality. During one pre-conference, the clinical supervisor demonstrated strong knowledge of the Arkansas K–12 Standards and the ATR, clearly explaining how candidate submissions align with specific rubric components and identifying resources to support instructional planning. However, the coaching conversation appeared largely scripted, with limited differentiation based on the candidate’s individual needs and no explicit linkage to instructional goals or progress monitoring. Other observed interactions included content-specific guidance and resource sharing, but did not consistently demonstrate coaching toward measurable growth.

Metric 4: Quality of feedback to candidates
APPROACHING

Program documentation provides some evidence that clinical supervisors provide effective instructional feedback, though consistency and impact vary. Submitted summative observation artifacts include examples of written feedback with specific, actionable guidance, such as discouraging round-robin reading, recommending alternative strategies with linked resources (e.g., Edutopia), and advising on lesson pacing, higher-level questioning, differentiation, and alignment between objectives and assessments. Walk-through tools and Task 3 assessment comments demonstrate attention to instructional quality and reference evidence-based practices; however, while these samples show that some supervisors provide effective coaching, the documentation does not establish that this level of feedback is consistently provided by most supervisors across candidates or over time.

In the teacher candidate focus group (n=8), participants reported receiving frequent verbal feedback, though only two indicated receiving written feedback. Most examples of support focused on responsiveness and general guidance rather than sustained instructional coaching. One candidate shared a concrete example of impact, explaining that after a supervisor identified student difficulty with the “-ng” and “-nk” sounds and suggested word sorting, “76% of my class passed that assessment,” compared to over half who had previously struggled. While this example demonstrates a positive impact, it was the only instance cited that clearly linked supervisor feedback to measurable student outcomes.

Observational evidence showed mixed quality of coaching interactions. In some conferences, supervisors identified instructional trends (such as pacing issues), connected feedback to student needs, and described shifts toward more robust feedback models, including combining verbal and written feedback within the POP Cycle and referencing TESS expectations. In other observed exchanges, feedback relied heavily on scripted questioning, offered limited actionable next steps, or consisted primarily of affirmation without reference to ATR, TESS, or prior feedback.

Note: The Aspiring Teacher Rubric must be in use by EPPs by the 2024–25 academic year.

Criteria 2.2c: Strong partnerships exist between the EPP and K12 schools and districts that facilitate the development of strong candidates
APPROACHING

Metric 1: Quality of partnership with districts/schools
APPROACHING

Program documentation indicates that some collaborative processes are in place to support and co-construct the clinical internship experience with district and school partners. Materials from the Annual Stakeholders’ Meeting, including agendas, slide decks, and attendance records, show that program partners are invited to participate and that administrators, mentor teachers, and university personnel are represented. Additional documentation reflects communication between university supervisors and experienced mentor teachers, including periodic check-ins related to MAT candidates. Together, these artifacts demonstrate that collaboration occurs and that partners have opportunities to contribute to candidate support and development.

In the partnership focus group, participants described communication as largely informal and conducted on an as-needed basis rather than through a clearly defined, structured process. One participant explained that because the district is “small” and “rural,” collaboration functions as a “codependency—we need them and they need us,” suggesting strong relational ties but not an intentionally designed communication system. While the four focus group participants felt supported, they relied more on proximity to the EPP, and there was no evidence provided of formalized partnership structures for the school partners across the state.

Metric 2: Support and development for clinical supervisors
APPROACHING

Program documentation indicates that some collaborative structures exist to support clinical supervisors, including access to HQIM training, TESS training, and discussions of expectations through Zoom meetings that reference the Aspiring Teacher Rubric (ATR). Supervisors also have access to coaching-related professional learning through Arkansas IDEAS, specifically Student-Centered Coaching modules, which support ongoing development and alignment with instructional expectations. These opportunities suggest that the program has mechanisms to communicate expectations and provide access to relevant professional learning.

However, evidence shows that much of the supervisors’ professional development occurs through their roles as district or school employees rather than through intentional, EPP-led collaborative processes. Coaching training described by supervisors was part of their day-to-day work in partner districts, not a structured or recurring system designed by the EPP to develop clinical supervisors collectively. There was no evidence that supervisors engage in EPP-facilitated norming, calibration on coaching practices, or regular collaborative learning focused specifically on their role as clinical supervisors.

INDICATOR 2.3: DEVELOPMENT

Criteria 2.3a: Candidates are successful with their program coursework
MEETS

Metric 1: Candidate proficiency in coursework
MEETS

Most candidates show proficiency in their coursework requirements. The document “December 24–August 25 Grads” shows that all graduate candidates have a GPA of 3.0 or higher at graduation.

Metric 2: Quality of candidate support across coursework
MEETS

Candidates are consistently provided with an individualized support plan if their coursework requirements are not on track. Evidence provided demonstrates that there are consistent procedures to provide candidates with individualized support when they are struggling with their coursework. The “MAT GPA Watch List” tracks candidates who are not meeting GPA requirements, and the “MAT Course Grade Progress Email” provides an example of communication to notify candidates who are falling behind.

In the Course Instructor focus group, participants explained how candidates receive support when they are falling behind, saying, “support is offered through multiple avenues by phone, Zoom, and email, and we try to make contact through a 24-hour response policy. When students struggle, faculty intentionally “take it back to their point of need,” identifying exactly which part of the content requires attention, and if “more than two or three” candidates demonstrate the same misunderstanding, instruction or assessment is taught for clarity. Tutoring is available for the Foundations of Reading, and academic alerts through the university initiate a protocol in which a faculty member contacts the student. One participant said, “We have a closeness, we will pull that student in,” emphasizing close communication among faculty.”

Criteria 2.3b: Candidates are successful in their clinical internship
APPROACHING

Metric 1: Candidate attainment of clinical internship goals and milestones

APPROACHING

Documents reviewed indicate that the EPP has established articulated goals and milestones for candidates' clinical internships and maintains systems to track progress. Artifacts such as "Licensure – Internships Fall 2025," "Pop Cycle Data–MAT," and "MAT Walkthrough Checklist Data" demonstrate that the program monitors individual candidate progress and reviews cohort-level data. Internship expectations and completion criteria are also described in course syllabi, providing transparency around required benchmarks and performance expectations.

In the clinical experience focus group (n=8), however, candidate awareness of these goals and milestones was limited. Only three participants (37%) were able to identify their personal clinical goals or milestones, and several candidates described difficulty navigating where this information is housed. One participant shared, "There is a lot of information in Blackboard to sift through, so you just have to go in there a lot." These responses suggest that while goals and milestones exist and are documented, they are not consistently communicated or internalized by candidates as part of a coherent, system-wide process.

In the clinical supervisor focus group, participants described tracking candidate attainment of goals and milestones and providing guidance when candidates are unsure of expectations. One supervisor explained, "I printed out everything the EPP gave us and made a folder for each candidate... we know the grades we have to have." Another noted that she reviews plans and provides verbal feedback so candidates understand the required scores before submission. While these practices demonstrate individual supervisor efforts to support candidates, the variability in candidate awareness indicates that goals and milestones are not yet reinforced consistently across the program.

Metric 2: Candidate impact on student growth

MEETS

There is adequate evidence that candidates have the capacity to impact student growth. Evidence provided showed alignment from planning to instruction, then to assessment in the three key tasks candidates are required to submit. Task 3 gives candidates the opportunity to assess students by submitting formative assessments and work samples, analyzing data, and identifying areas for growth.

In the clinical experience focus group (n=6), all participants confirmed that they regularly discuss student growth with their mentor teacher or clinical supervisor. Candidates articulated multiple ways they monitor and interpret student learning, including formative assessments, classroom discussions, and benchmark data such as ATLAS and NWEA. One candidate explained how assessment data informed understanding of student learning in both math and reading, while five participants shared specific examples of positive impact on students, including academic growth and personal development.

In one observed lesson and coaching conversation, the candidate articulated instructional and assessment decisions using ATLAS results, identified underlying student needs, and described intentional adjustments such as targeted small-group instruction and real-time corrections based on student performance.

Metric 3: Candidate proficiency in effective teaching skills

MEETS

Based on the evidence provided, most candidates receive a score of "effective" on the Aspiring Teacher Rubric at the end of their clinical internship. The "Pop Cycle Data–MAT" document shows the progression in scores from Spring 2024 (most scores below 3.00) to Spring 2025 (ratings for all but two components averaging above 3.0).

Note: By 2024–25, evidence that the Aspiring Teacher Rubric is in use by EPPs must be shown to meet this metric.

Metric 4: Quality of candidate support across clinical internship

APPROACHING

Program documents indicate that the EPP has some structures in place to identify and respond to candidate performance. Documentation shows that feedback is provided to candidates and improvement plans are created that outline next steps and require the candidate to take an active part in monitoring their progress. There is also evidence of recognizing high-performing candidates through public acknowledgements, such as spotlights on the School of Education's social media page, highlighting candidate accomplishments.

In the clinical supervisor focus group, participants demonstrated limited awareness and involvement in both individualized support plans and retention efforts for high-performing candidates. Supervisors stated that they were aware that individualized support plans existed for some candidates, but were not directly involved in developing,

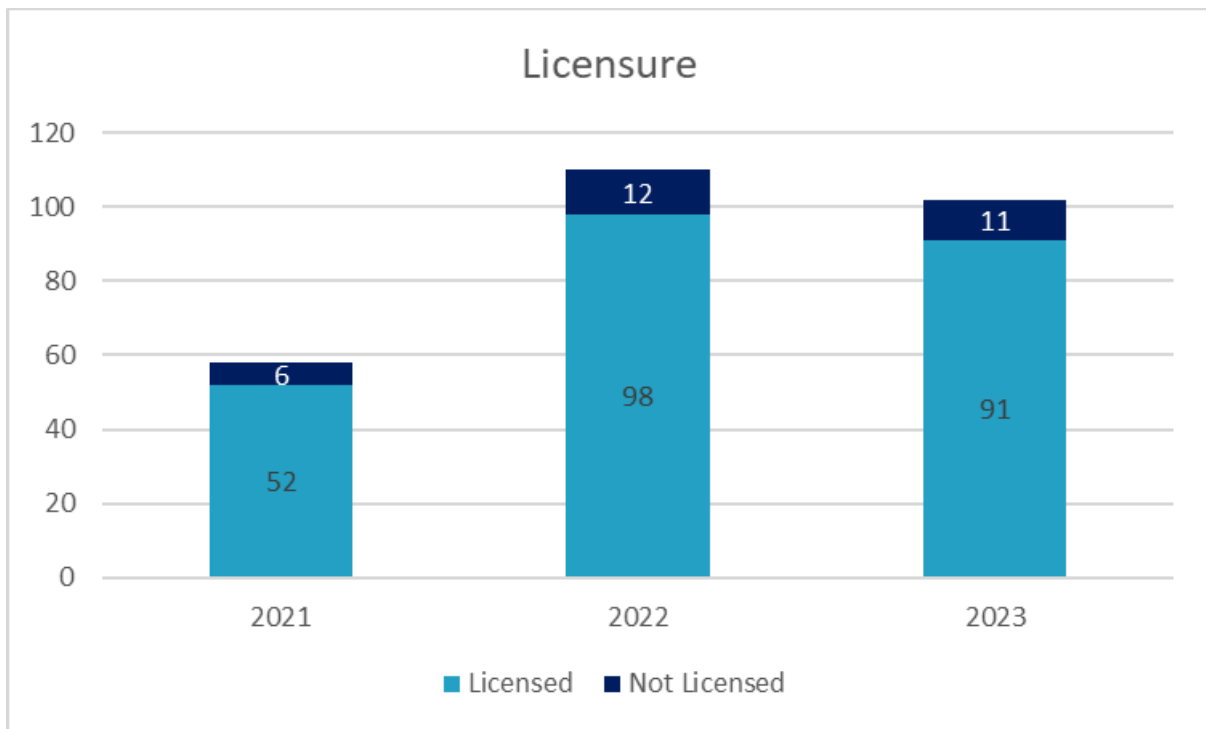
monitoring, or implementing them. One supervisor shared, “I am not involved in them, but I know that they have them,” while another referenced candidates completing an additional semester with added support without direct supervisor engagement. Supervisors were also unable to describe intentional strategies for supporting or retaining high-performing candidates beyond general encouragement. Observations of lessons and coaching sessions did not provide evidence of individualized support plans in action or targeted strategies for retaining high performers.

STANDARD 3: SUPPORTING WORKFORCE NEEDS

Standard 3 Performance Level		
MEETS		
Indicator Performance Levels		
Indicator 3.1 Licensure	Indicator 3.2 Employment	Indicator 3.3 Effectiveness
APPROACHING	EXCEEDS	EXCEEDS
Recommendations		
Recommendations include: Establish programmatic support to ensure that alternative program enrollees who are employed obtain provisional licensure and are prepared to obtain standard licensure immediately following completion. <i>(Focus Areas: Criteria 3.1b)</i>		

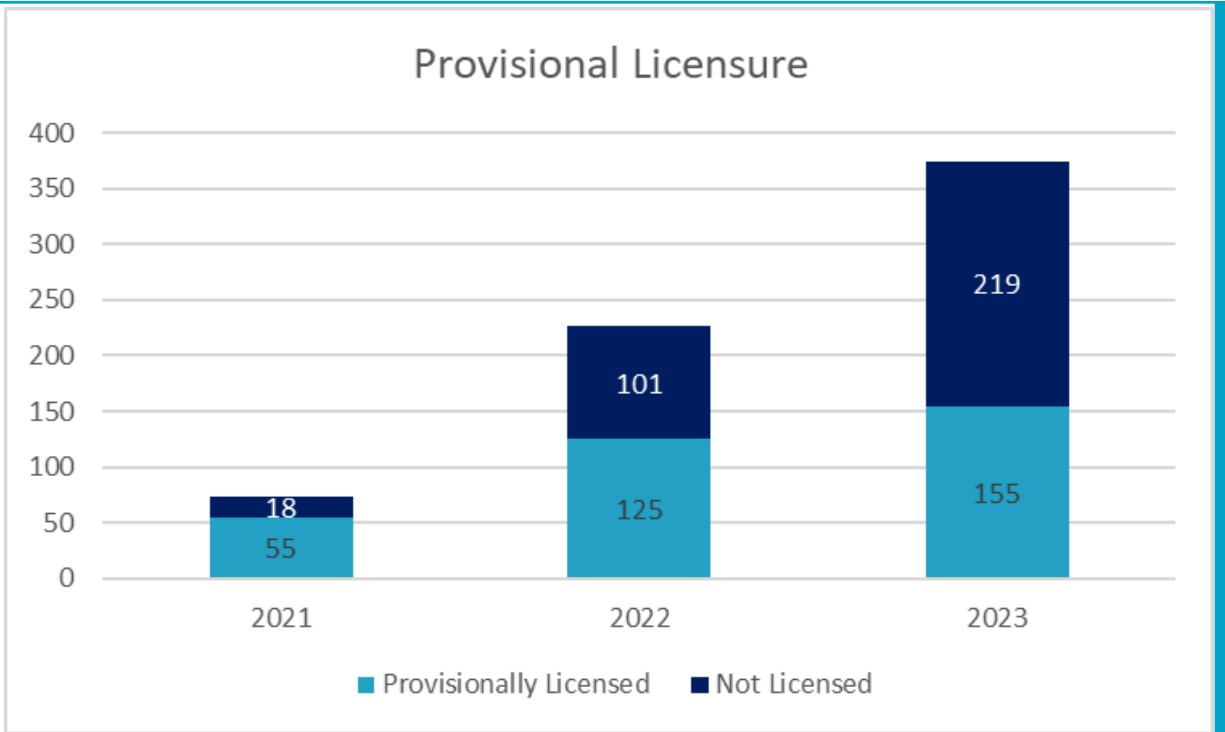
INDICATOR 3.1: LICENSURE

Criteria 3.1a: A high proportion of program candidates obtain a standard license			
Metric	Target	EPP's Percentage Licensed	Performance Level
Percentage of completers who have earned a standard license within one year of completion	80%	89%	EXCEEDS



Criteria 3.1b: A high proportion of alternative route enrollees are provisionally licensed

Metric	Target	EPP's Percentage Licensed	Performance Level
Percentage of employed alternative route enrollees who are provisionally licensed	73%	50%	BELOW

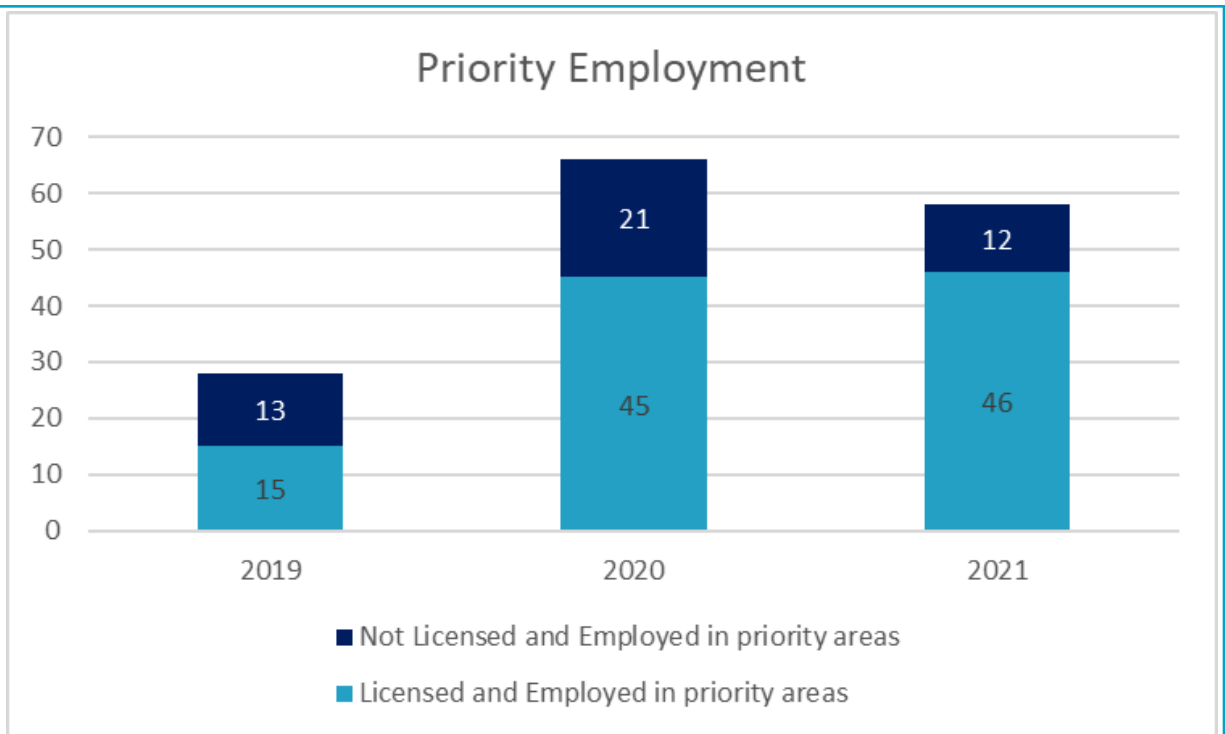


Criteria 3.1c: A high proportion of traditional program candidates pass the content exam in their area on the first try

Metric	Target	EPP's First-Time Pass Percentage	Performance Level
Percentage of first-time licensure exam test takers that pass on their first try	66%	N/A	N/A

INDICATOR 3.2: EMPLOYMENT

Criteria 3.2a: A high proportion of completers are employed in Arkansas public schools															
Metric	Target	EPP's Percentage Employed	Performance Level												
Percentage of completers who are licensed and gain employment in Arkansas public schools in their first three years after completion	68%	82%	EXCEEDS												
Employment <table><thead><tr><th>Year</th><th>Licensed and Employed</th><th>Not Licensed and Employed</th></tr></thead><tbody><tr><td>2019</td><td>17</td><td>11</td></tr><tr><td>2020</td><td>55</td><td>11</td></tr><tr><td>2021</td><td>52</td><td>6</td></tr></tbody></table>				Year	Licensed and Employed	Not Licensed and Employed	2019	17	11	2020	55	11	2021	52	6
Year	Licensed and Employed	Not Licensed and Employed													
2019	17	11													
2020	55	11													
2021	52	6													
Criteria 3.2b: A high proportion of completers work in high-priority Arkansas public school districts and subjects															
Metric	Target	EPP's Percentage Employed Priority	Performance Level												
Percentage of completers who are licensed and gain employment in high-priority Arkansas public school districts and subjects in their first three years after completion	39%	70%	EXCEEDS												



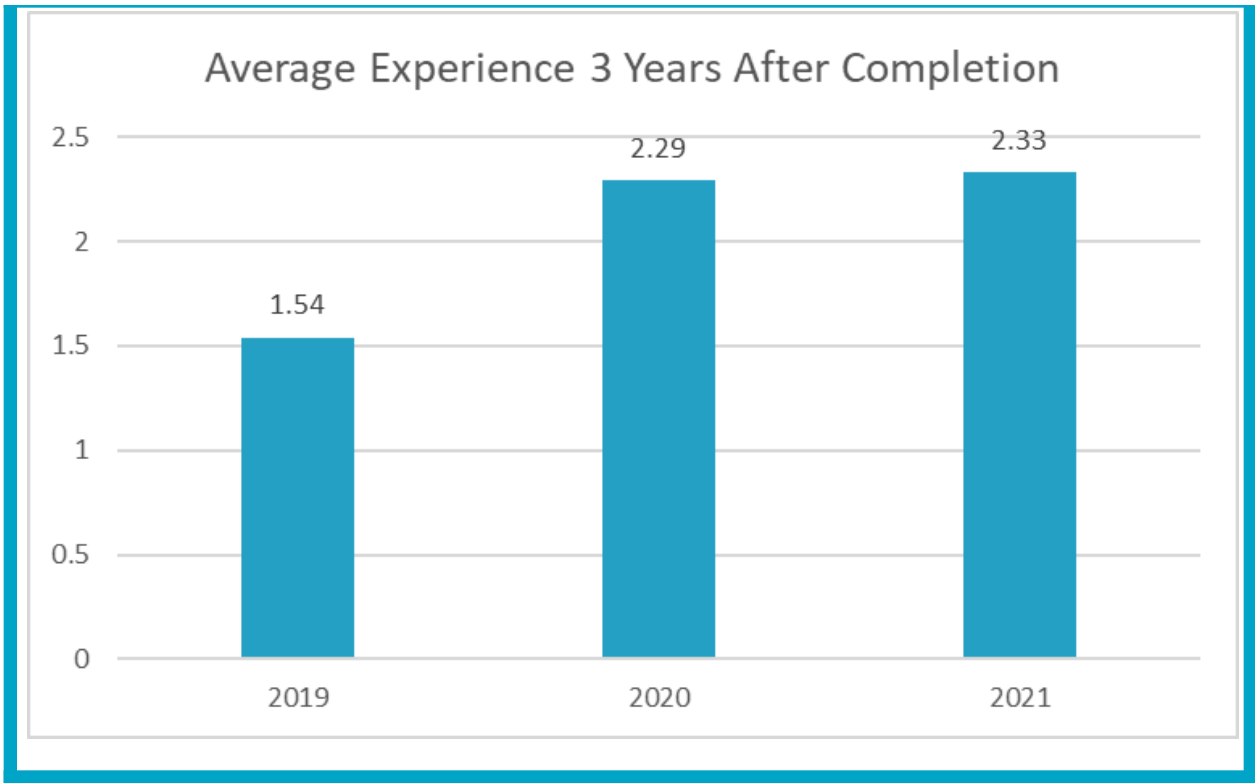
*Priority Employment is employment in a high-need subject area and/or geographical shortage area. Shortage Areas are based on an analysis of 3yrs of data related to teacher supply (EPP pipeline) and demand (unlicensed teachers, attrition, deceased) and state focus areas.

Current subject shortage areas for employment: Secondary Science, Foreign Language, Secondary Math, Middle School Math, Middle School Science, and Special Education.

Current geographical shortage areas are school districts located in the following co-op regions: Arkansas River ESC, Great Rivers ESC, Pulaski Co Schools, Southeast AR ESC.

Criteria 3.2c: Program completers remain in the classroom for multiple years

Metric	Target	EPP's Average Years of Experience, 3 Years After Completion	Performance Level
Program completers' average licensed teaching experience in Arkansas's public schools 3 years after completion	1.8	2.2	EXCEEDS



INDICATOR 3.3: EFFECTIVENESS

Criteria 3.3a: School leaders rate program completers that they hire as effective classroom teachers			
Metric	Target	EPP's Average Percentage of Agree+ on all Survey Items	Performance Level
School leaders' perception of program completer effectiveness based on responses to the EPP Completer Supervisor Survey conducted annually by the DESE	78%	76%	MEETS
Criteria 3.3b: Completers feel that their program prepared them well to be a teacher			
Metric	Target	EPP's Average Percentage of Agree+ on all Survey Items	Performance Level
Program completers' perception of how well their program prepared them to be a teacher based on responses to the EPP Completer Survey conducted annually by the DESE	79%	80%	EXCEEDS
Criteria 3.3c: A high proportion of program completers have above-average value-added scores			
Metric	Target	EPP's Percentage with Average Value-Added of 80+	Performance Level
Percentage of program completers who have above-average value-added scores in their first three years after completion	43%	48%	EXCEEDS

